

Chapter 127-7

A week after waking up, Liang Shi returned home. This place was also spotlessly clean.

Moreover, as soon as she pushed open the door, she saw colorful balloons bumping against the ceiling, with words written on them in colored markers: Welcome Home.

Xiao Bai stood to the side acting as the atmosphere crew. A party popper went off, and confetti ribbons fell onto Liang Shi.

Through the huge floor-to-ceiling windows, Liang Shi could see this city's night view—lights sparkling brilliantly. Yet the light in her home was the most inconspicuous one in this entire city.

Xiao Bai shouted loudly: "Welcome home, Liang-jie!"

Liang Shi smiled helplessly: "You're cleaning this up later."

Xiao Bai's face immediately fell, and she said pitifully: "Can I clean it up tomorrow?"

Liang Shi said righteously: "No."

After returning home, Liang Shi's footsteps measured every floor tile. She and Wang Zhaozhao nestled on the sofa. After Xiao Bai finished sweeping up the confetti ribbons on the floor, she opened a bottle of wine.

Xiao Bai's eyes lit up after taking a sip. "Jie, this wine is really expensive, isn't it?!"

Liang Shi nodded.

Wang Zhaozhao was beside them, looking like a wealthy person showing off: "It's alright, just over two hundred thousand."

Xiao Bai: "..."

Liang Shi nestled in the corner of the sofa watching Bai Qi carefully take sip after sip, finally frowning and saying: "I don't taste any difference between this and wine that costs a few hundred."

Wang Zhaozhao: "Your palate isn't refined enough."

Xiao Bai looked dejected and let out a soft scoff, not quite daring to.

"Getting bold, are we?" Wang Zhaozhao threatened her.

Xiao Bai immediately backed down. "I was wrong."

During the days she had been unconscious in the hospital, the two of them had built up a unique rapport.

Wang Zhaozhao had finally come to appreciate Xiao Bai's good qualities, and Xiao Bai no longer rigidly thought of Wang Zhaozhao as "Wang the Slave Driver."¹

Watching them bicker, Liang Shi also felt very warm.

One expensive bottle of wine was finished by the three of them, and Liang Shi was already slightly tipsy.

This wine had quite an aftereffect.

After seeing that she was fine, Wang Zhaozhao and Xiao Bai left her home. Although Xiao Bai had worriedly asked if she wanted company tonight.

But Liang Shi declined.

After they left, Liang Shi took her newly returned phone and opened her social media apps.

Almost all of her social apps showed 99+.

Because she valued her privacy, Wang Zhaozhao hadn't touched her phone after she fell into a coma.

She now read through the messages one by one. Many artist friends had sent her messages of concern.

There was even one artist who came out: "Actually, I also like girls."

It was the third female lead she had worked with while filming before. She wasn't particularly outstanding in appearance, but had a gentle temperament and spoke softly—the kind of little sister that made people want to protect her.

Liang Shi finished reading through the messages one by one, then posted on her Moments²:
【Spring should be wonderful, if only you were still here.】

This was a song lyric.

A song Liang Shi had been listening to constantly these days.

She turned on the record player at home. The antique item with its unique sense of a bygone era pulled her into that old period of time, but her thoughts kept drifting.

A gentle voice sang in Cantonese, carrying a special charm.

Outside, the lights were bright, stars dotted the sky, and the moon hung high above.

This was the most ordinary spring.

Yet it was a spring without Xu Qingzhu.

The golden millet dream had ended.

Yesterday's scene would never return.

Liang Shi curled up alone in the corner of the sofa, unable to sleep through the long, endless night.

1. "Wang the Slave Driver" (王扒皮) - A nickname playing on Wang Zhaozhao's surname. "扒皮" literally means "skin-peeler" and is a reference to a notorious landlord character from Chinese revolutionary literature known for exploiting workers. It's used colloquially to describe someone who is very demanding or harsh, like a slave driver. ⇐
2. Moments (朋友圈) - WeChat's social media feature similar to Facebook's timeline/feed, where users can post updates, photos, and thoughts that their friends can see and interact with. ⇐